

Street projects confront delays

Policy change under Wu sparks major bottleneck

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

While she once unapologetically championed bike and bus lanes and other street safety improvements, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu has since substantially slowed, or entirely stalled progress on many of these, by requiring her personal approval on most transit and road safety projects, numerous current and former city employees told the Globe.

Wu imposed the new policy more than a year ago, at a time when she faced such a backlash over bike lanes that her mayoral challenger made them a central issue of his campaign, according to four people familiar with the decision. The change marked a dramatic shift in her so-called Streets Cabinet, whose leaders previously had the autonomy to advance most projects, those people said.

That directive, which hasn't been previously reported, has brought the vast majority of the city's street projects involving design or infrastructure changes to a near standstill for the past

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Healey cuts back on public events

Reelection bid may lead to shift

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

As potential opponents lined up against her reelection bid and President Trump began upending Washington, Governor Maura Healey significantly scaled back the number of official events she did last year, putting her in the Massachusetts public eye far less often than early in her first term, according to a Globe analysis and data provided by her office.

Healey did 20 percent fewer official events last year — and nearly 100 fewer in total — than she did in 2023, when she first took office. Her public-facing schedule similarly receded: Healey's 289 public appearances in 2025, as tracked by the advisories her office regularly releases, marked a 17 percent decrease from two years earlier and trailed the number she made in 2024, when she regularly traveled out of state in support of other Democrats in the run-up to that year's election, the Globe found.

HEALEY, Page A6

Over the past decade, the life expectancy gap between Black residents and other Bostonians has doubled.



For Black men, the numbers are worse.

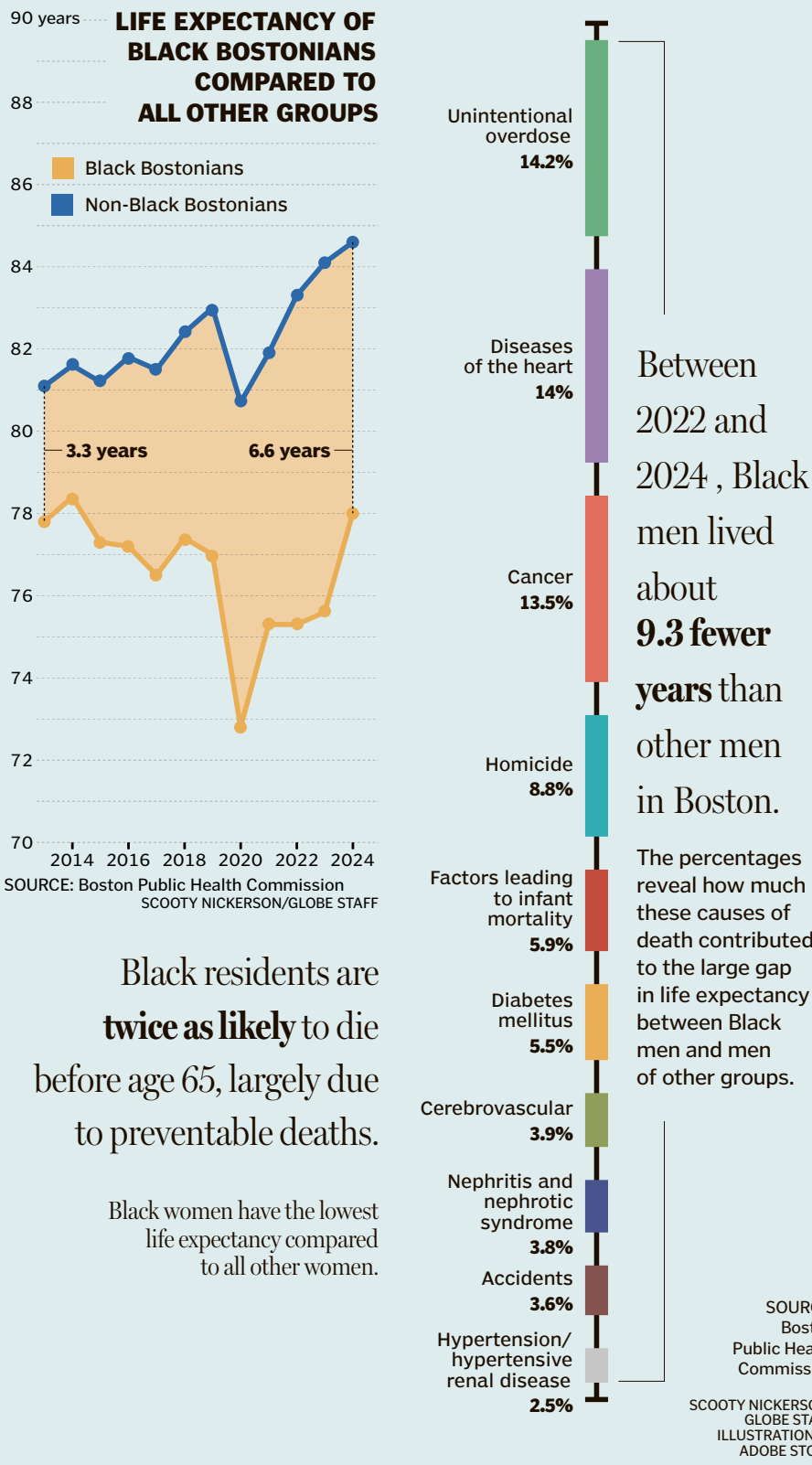
By Lauren Albano and Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT AND GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts residents are living longer than nearly the rest of the country, but in Boston you'll find the life expectancy for Black residents is lagging far behind the rest of the city.

The gap between how long Black residents are living compared to the rest of Boston has doubled. Black residents are twice as likely to die before age 65, largely due to preventable causes, such as dying of drug overdose or cancer, according to a new city report.

Black men in Boston live to around 72 years, despite the overall city reaching an all-time high expectancy of around 82 years. In other cities, such as Philadelphia, where Black men live to 65, their lives are shorter, but the disparity is slightly wider in Boston.

LIFESPAN, Page A10



A painful math: Districts weigh school closures

Fewer students, higher costs lead to cuts, anger

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

As student enrollment drops across Massachusetts and expenses rise, districts are showing a willingness to take on one of the most polarizing issues in public education: closing or merging schools.

The downsizing has popped up in a wide variety of urban, rural, and suburban districts, including Acton-Boxborough and Belchertown in Hampshire County, which are both shuttering an elementary school in June. Boston is also closing three schools this summer as it strives to eliminate nearly one-fifth of its schools.

The impending shutdowns — a trend that is expected to continue in the coming years — add to more than three dozen public schools that have closed or consolidated since the pandemic disrupted classroom learning. That list includes shuttered elementary schools in Cambridge, North Middlesex, and Wellesley districts, and the closure or merger of several charter schools.

District leaders have pursued the closures and mergers to balance operating budgets amid declining enrollment and rising costs for special education, transportation, utilities, and other expenses, or to curb spending on replacing antiquated school buildings as construction costs have soared.

The efforts have sparked scores of protests from parents, educators, and other community members, who worry about losing close-knit communities and whether districts will be short on space if enrollment rebounds.

In Acton, Molly Sparrow will be constantly reminded of the Conant School's closure long after the final bell rings in June. The school is across the street

SCHOOLS, Page A7

‘It’s 100 percent worth it. You only get one body. It’s worth investing in it.’

JOHN BLAZO



JOHN TLUMACKI/BOSTON GLOBE

John Blazo relaxed as an IV with immunity defense fluids was administered at Vivolo Wellness Club in Charlestown.

A shot in the arm or a hole in the wallet?

IV bars trendy; doctors, nurses urge caution

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

It's Friday afternoon — cocktail time for John Blazo. But instead of elbowing up to a bar, he sank into a leather recliner at a wellness spa in Charlestown, cracked open a can of Raspberry Lime Polar Seltzer, and rolled up his sleeve.

For the next 45 minutes, the “cocktail,” an IV solution of vitamins, dripped slowly into his bloodstream — a weekly ritual he believes helps him perform better at work and while running long distances.

Blazo changes his order depending on his needs. That Friday, he selected a boosted version of an immunity treatment at Vivolo Wellness that includes a liter of fluids and smaller amounts of vitamins, and Blazo added 1,000 milligrams of vitamin C and 1,000 milligrams of the antioxidant Glutathione through an IV drip and a 100 milligram shot to the shoulder of NAD+, a supplement popular with wellness influencers.

“I would always get flus and colds a couple times a year,” said Blazo, 34, an attorney and Vivolo regular. “But what really drove me here is performance and wellness. I don’t get sick at

IVS, Page A10



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

CAPTURING A WEE BIT O' JOY

Parade goers reached out for confetti during the annual St. Patrick's Day parade in South Boston on Sunday. **B1.**



The big dripper

Monday: Warm and rainy. High 60-65, low 39-44.

Tuesday: Cooler, clearing. High 43-48, low 22-27.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **B6.**

Allies and China have yet to commit to help protect the Strait of Hormuz from Iranian control despite President Trump's appeal for them to send naval escorts for tankers. **A4.**

Bracket breakdown: The NCAA men's and women's tournament seedings were announced. **C4-5.**

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“One Battle After Another” won best picture, picking up a total of six Oscars while “Sinners” won four, including best actor for Michael B. Jordan, at the Academy Awards. **C10.**

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